Figure 5. Workforce and Structural Capacity

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Practicing workforce												
Overall physicians per 1000 population	Germany 4.8	Sweden 4.7	CHE 4.7	Denmark 4.7	Australia 4.3	NLD 4.0	France 3.9	UK 3.5	US 2.7	Canada 2.7	Japan 2.7	3.9
Primary care physicians, % of total	Canada 51	NLD 48	Australia 44	France 38	CHE 31	UK 29	Germany 27	US 21	Denmark 21	Sweden 15	Japan NA	32 (n = 10)
Specialists, % of total	Sweden 85	Denmark 79	US 79	Germany 73	UK 71	CHE 69	France 62	Australia 56	NLD 52	Canada 50	Japan NA	67 (n = 10)
Nurses per 1000 population	CHE 19.0	Australia 13.4	US 12.6[e]	Japan 12.6	Germany 12.5	NLD 11.2	Sweden 11.1	Denmark 10.5	Canada 10.2	UK 9.3	France 8.9	11.9
Workforce remuneration, US $												
Generalist physicians[b]	US 298 000	Germany 290 314	UK 248 913	CHE 239 612	France 194 521	Canada 194 315	NLD 186 939	Japan 153 308[a]	Sweden 143 102	Denmark 140 656	Australia 139 970	202 695
Specialist physicians[b]	US 417 000	Canada 304 083	CHE 266 632	NLD 244 321	Australia 238 134	Germany 229 534	UK 201 171	Denmark 190 450	France 146 823	Sweden 137 526	Japan NA	237 567 (n = 10)
Nurses[b]	US 103 729	NLD 99 132	Australia 88 764	Denmark 83 031	Germany 81 723	CHE 76 257	Canada 73 522	Sweden 62 900	France 61 767	UK 58 187	Japan 53 668	76 607
Non-health-specific annual wage, mean[c]	CHE 92 285	US 86 977	NLD 80 136	Denmark 78 090	Germany 76 285	Australia 72 018	Canada 67 901	UK 66 299	Sweden 61 443	France 60 483	Japan 50 183	72 009
Ratio of generalist remuneration to mean wage[d]	Germany 3.9	UK 3.7	US 3.4	France 3.4	Canada 2.8	CHE 2.7	NLD 2.3	Sweden 2.3	Australia 1.9	Denmark 1.8	Japan NA	2.8 (n = 10)
Ratio of specialists remuneration to mean wage[d]	US 4.8	Canada 4.4	UK 3.4	Australia 3.3	NLD 3.1	Germany 3.0	CHE 2.9	Denmark 2.4	France 2.4	Sweden 2.2	Japan NA	3.2 (n = 10)
Ratio of nurse remuneration to mean wage[d]	NLD 1.22	Australia 1.22	US 1.21	Germany 1.14	Canada 1.06	Denmark 1.04	Japan 1.03	Sweden 1.00	France 0.99	UK 0.87	CHE 0.84	1.06
Equipment per 1 million population												
Magnetic resonance imaging units	Japan 59.8	US 38.0	Germany 37.9	France 20.6	Australia 20.0	Sweden 17.9	Denmark 16.1	NLD 15.4	Canada 10.4	UK 9.4	CHE NA	24.5 (n = 10)
Computed tomography units	Japan 119.8	Australia 80.0	US 42.6	CHE 40.6	Germany 38.0	Denmark 29.1	Sweden 23.6	France 21.9	NLD 17.5	Canada 14.2	UK 10.9	39.8
Mammography machine units	US 77.7	Japan 33.5	CHE 29.3	Australia 19.7	Canada 16.7	Denmark 16.4	Sweden 11.0	UK 7.3	Germany NA	France NA	NLD NA	26.4 (n = 8)
Beds												
Hospital beds per 1000 population	Japan 12.5	Germany 7.6	France 5.3	CHE 4.2	Australia 3.8	US 2.7	UK 2.4	Canada 2.4	NLD 2.2	Denmark 2.1	Sweden 1.9	4.3
Long-term beds per 1000 population aged ≥65 y[f]	NLD 68.0	Sweden 63.1	CHE 58.3	Germany 53.0	France 45.1	Australia 44.7	Canada 43.2	UK 41.0	Denmark 35.0	US 27.2	Japan 26.9	46.0

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right. Primary care physicians are generalist medical practitioners plus general pediatricians as a share of all physicians (OECD); unlike the 2018 functionality-based definition, general internists and geriatricians are counted as specialists because they cannot be separated in OECD or Eurostat data. Remuneration numbers may be an underestimate in some countries (eg, Canada) because they do not account for practice expenses for self-employed physicians.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Combined generalist and specialist figure for Japan (salaried physicians in general hospitals); Japan is excluded from the generalist and specialist ratios.

[b] Annual remuneration in current-price US dollar purchasing power parities for the latest year, converted to 2025 US dollars with the US Consumer Price Index (CPI-U), as in the 2018 paper. US values are average total compensation (Medscape) and are not from OECD.

[c] In 2025 constant prices at 2025 US dollar purchasing power parities.

[d] Remuneration divided by the average annual wage for the same country and year (both in current-price US dollar purchasing power parities).

[e] Professionally active nurses; the US does not report practising nurses.

[f] Beds in long-term care institutions only (OECD no longer publishes institutions plus hospitals).

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2016–2025; most values 2023–2025); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: OECD Data Explorer (Health Statistics: physicians by category, nurses, remuneration of health professionals, medical technology, hospital and long-term care beds; average annual wages); US physician remuneration, Medscape Physician Compensation Report 2026 (2025 earnings); Japan, Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare Survey on Economic Conditions in Health Care (FY2024); US CPI-U, Bureau of Labor Statistics.